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WAM

MOHAMED MEETS US SENATOR LINDSEY GRAHAM

■ President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday received Lindsey Graham, member of the US Senate. During the meeting at Qasr Al Shati in Abu Dhabi, the two sides discussed the friendship and strategic cooperation between the UAE and the United States and their shared commitment to strengthening their partnership in support of mutual interests. The meeting also addressed regional developments, as well as matters concerning regional security and stability and joint efforts to promote peace in the Middle East and beyond.

Medical fitness tests made easier

Dubai Health rolls out unified screening, simplifying residence visa process

DUBAI

BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

A new ‘Unified Health Screening’ service has been launched by Dubai Health that combines residency and occupational health medical fitness examinations into a single, seamless application process, with residency issued automatically once medical results are finalised.

By merging medical fit-

ness and occupational health screenings into one automated digital pathway, the initiative enables applicants to complete all required examinations in a single visit.

‘City Makers’ initiative

Introduced under the ‘City Makers’ initiative, the service marks a significant step in enhancing government integration and simplifying procedures for residents and professionals across sectors. Through a smart digital platform, professionals can apply for health screenings based on their selected profession. The system automatically determines the required tests, ensuring all procedures are completed in one streamlined

journey. Once medical results are approved, residency permits are issued automatically, eliminating duplication and reducing processing time.

The initiative also connects databases across relevant authorities, enabling faster, more accurate data exchange and reinforcing preventive planning. The project has been implemented in collaboration with key government entities, including the Dubai Health Authority (DHA), the General Directorate of Identity and Foreigners Affairs – Dubai (GDRFA Dubai), Dubai Municipality, the Supreme Legislation Committee, and the Department of Finance.

SEE ALSO P2

Iran, Russia to hold drills amid US build-up

TEHRAN HASN’T ACKNOWLEDGED ALL OF WASHINGTON’S RED LINES: VANCE

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Iran and Russia are set to launch joint naval manoeuvres in the Sea of Oman today, Iranian media reported, as a massive US military build-up and escalating rhetoric continue to stoke tensions across the Gulf despite ongoing diplomacy between Tehran and Washington.

The drills come at a particularly sensitive moment, with American carrier strike groups positioned within operational reach of Iran and Tehran staging its own exercises near the strategic Strait of Hormuz – one of the world’s most critical energy corridors.

The overlapping military movements underscore the fragile security environment surrounding the renewed US–Iran negotiations. Analysts warn that such parallel signalling – diplomacy accompanied by conspicuous shows of force – often amplifies the risk of miscalculation rather than reducing it.

Sabre-rattling

Iran’s Revolutionary Guards launched drills in the Strait of Hormuz, briefly restricting passage through the narrow waterway on Tuesday for what officials described as “security” reasons.

Iran’s semi-official Isna news agency, citing drill spokesman Rear Admiral Hassan Maghsoudloo, said the joint Iran–Russia exercise would extend across the

● **The naval activity coincides with cautious diplomatic engagement between Tehran and Washington in Geneva, mediated by Oman.**

Sea of Oman and parts of the northern Indian Ocean.

“The aim is to strengthen maritime security and to deepen relations between the navies of the two countries,” Maghsoudloo said.

The naval activity coincides with cautious diplomatic engagement between Tehran and Washington in Geneva, mediated by Oman. Iranian officials have described the talks as constructive, saying discussions yielded agreement on broad “guiding principles” aimed at avoiding conflict.

US officials, however, have adopted a more guarded tone. Vice-President JD Vance said Tehran had yet to acknowledge all of Washington’s red lines, highlighting persistent gaps that continue to cloud prospects for a breakthrough.

Meanwhile, US Energy Secretary Chris Wright warned that Washington would deter Iran from acquiring nuclear weapons “one way or the other.”

“They’ve been very clear about what they would do with nuclear weapons. It’s entirely unacceptable,” Wright said.

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PRAYER TIMINGS

IFTAR 18:19

Fajr	05:33	Shuruq	06:47
Dhuhr	12:35	Asr	15:50
Maghrib	18:19	Isha	19:33

IMSAK 05:23

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah

ENTERTAINMENT

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Zuckerberg to testify in social media addiction trial

Plaintiff alleges platforms deliberately designed to make young users addicted

CALIFORNIA

Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg was set to testify later yesterday at a groundbreaking social media addiction trial, summoned by lawyers representing a plaintiff who alleges Instagram and other platforms were deliberately designed to make young users addicted.

The 41-year-old head of Meta – which owns Facebook, Instagram and WhatsApp – is the most anticipated witness in the California trial, the first in a series of cases that could set legal precedent for thousands of lawsuits filed by American families against major social media platforms.

First time

The trial will mark the first time the multimillionaire will address the safety of his world-dominating platforms directly before a jury.

The 12 jurors in Los Ange-



AFP

■ Mark Zuckerberg

les will hear testimony until late March to decide whether Google-owned YouTube and Meta’s Instagram bear any responsibility for the mental health problems suffered by Kaley G.M., a 20-year-old California resident who has been a heavy social media user since childhood. Kaley G.M. started using YouTube at age 6, Instagram at 11, then TikTok and Snapchat.

The trial will determine whether Google and Meta deliberately designed their platforms to encourage compulsive use among young people, damaging their mental health in the process. The proceedings focus solely on app design, algorithms and personalisation features – AFP

This Ramadan,
nobody drinks tea alone.

A little Ramadan story from FiLLi

Scan to watch!